

Emails I: Structure and Tone

Trainee Worksheet 5

Name: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Today's mission:

Write short professional emails that are clear, polite and complete.

Remember

A professional email does not need to be long.

It needs to be clear, polite and complete.

Useful rule: Short is fine. Unclear is not.

Learning goals

- Recognise the main parts of a short professional email.
- Use an appropriate subject line, greeting and closing.
- Write short emails to request information, give information and confirm arrangements.
- Improve email tone: not too direct, not too informal, but professional.
- Review and improve your own email using a simple checklist.

Warm-up - Phone or email?

Work in pairs. Discuss the questions and write short notes.

1. When do you prefer to use the phone at work?

2. When do you prefer to send an email?

3. What can go wrong in a professional email?

Activity 1 - Good email or bad email?

Read the email extracts. In pairs, choose the best label. Then improve at least two weak examples.

Labels

☒ Professional | ☐ Too informal | ☒ Too direct | ☐ Unclear

No.	Email extract	Label	Better version / notes
1	Send me the document today.	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	
2	Could you please send me the document today?	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	
3	Hi, I need stuff for the meeting.	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	
4	I am writing to ask for the documents for tomorrow's meeting.	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	
5	Thanks. Bye.	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	
6	Thank you for your help. Kind regards, Ana Silva.	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	
7	Meeting changed. Room 204 now.	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	
8	I am writing to inform you that the meeting room has changed to Room 204.	☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ ?	

Mini challenge: Rewrite two weak extracts professionally.

Activity 2 - The structure of a professional email

A short professional email usually has 7 parts. Read the model and highlight each part.

1 Subject	2 Greeting	3 Purpose	4 Key information	5 Request/ action	6 Closing	7 Sign-off
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Model email

Subject: Meeting confirmation - 12 March

Dear Ms Ferreira,

I am writing to confirm your meeting with Mr Costa on Tuesday, 12 March, at 10:30.

The meeting will take place in Room 204, on the second floor. Please come to reception when you arrive.

Please let me know if you need any further information.

Kind regards,
 Ana Silva

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What is the purpose of the email?	
What is the key information?	
What action does the visitor need to take?	
What phrase makes the email polite?	

Activity 3 - Email reconstruction

The email below is mixed up. Put the parts in the correct order. Write numbers 1-7 in the first column.

Order	Mixed email part	Email part name
—	Kind regards, Marta Lopes	☐ subject ☐ greeting ☐ purpose ☐ information ☐ request ☐ closing ☐ sign-off
—	Could you please send me the updated visitor list by 3 p.m.?	☐ subject ☐ greeting ☐ purpose ☐ information ☐ request ☐ closing ☐ sign-off
—	Dear Mr Green,	☐ subject ☐ greeting ☐ purpose ☐ information ☐ request ☐ closing ☐ sign-off
—	Thank you for your help.	☐ subject ☐ greeting ☐ purpose ☐ information ☐ request ☐ closing ☐ sign-off
—	I am writing about tomorrow's company event.	☐ subject ☐ greeting ☐ purpose ☐ information ☐ request ☐ closing ☐ sign-off
—	We need the final list before the reception team prepares the visitor badges.	☐ subject ☐ greeting ☐ purpose ☐ information ☐ request ☐ closing ☐ sign-off
—	Subject: Visitor list for tomorrow's event	☐ subject ☐ greeting ☐ purpose ☐ information ☐ request ☐ closing ☐ sign-off

Now write the complete email in the correct order.

Activity 4 - Tone ladder: improve the message

Emails can sound too direct or too informal. Work in pairs. Label each phrase and write a better professional version.

Helpful starters

Could you please ...?

Could you let me know ...?

I am writing to ...

Please find attached ...

Thank you for your help.

Please let me know if ...

Phrase	Too direct?	Too informal / unclear?	Better professional version
Send me the invoice.	☐	☐	
I want the file now.	☐	☐	
Hey, where's the document?	☐	☐	
I need info ASAP.	☐	☐	
The meeting is tomorrow. Be there.	☐	☐	
You sent the wrong file.	☐	☐	
Give me an answer today.	☐	☐	
I am writing to confirm the appointment.	☐	☐	

Useful language bank - Keep this page open when you write

Function	Useful phrases	
Greetings	- Dear Mr Costa, - Dear Ms Ferreira, - Dear Sir/Madam,	- Good morning, - Hello Ana,
Purpose	- I am writing to ask about... - I am writing to confirm... - I am writing to inform you that...	- I am contacting you about... - This email is about...
Requests	- Could you please send me...? - Could you please confirm...? - Could you please let me know...?	- Please send me... - Could you check this for me?
Giving information	- The meeting is scheduled for... - The appointment is confirmed for... - The room has changed to...	- The document is attached. - The delivery is expected on...
Closings	- Thank you for your help. - I look forward to your reply. - Best regards,	- Please let me know if you need anything else. - Kind regards,

Activity 5 - Guided writing: three micro-emails

Write three short professional emails. Use the models and phrase bank. Keep your emails clear, polite and complete.

Support template

Subject: _____
 Dear _____,
 I am writing to _____.
 The key information is: _____.
 Could you please _____?
 Thank you for your help.
 Kind regards, _____

Email 1 - Request

Situation: You work in the Administration Department. You need the updated visitor list for tomorrow's meeting. Write an email to Mr Green asking for the updated visitor list.

Include: why you need it | when you need it | a polite request | a closing.

Email 2 - Information

Situation: A visitor has a meeting with Ms Costa tomorrow at 11:00. The room has changed from Room 105 to Room 204. Write an email informing the visitor about the change.

Include: meeting date/time | new room | where the visitor should go first | polite closing.

Activity 5 - Guided writing continued

Email 3 - Confirmation

Situation: A supplier asked if the delivery appointment for Friday at 9:30 is confirmed. Write an email confirming the appointment.

Include: confirmation | date/time | delivery location | contact person if needed.

Activity 6 - Peer review: help your partner improve

Exchange one email with a partner. Read it carefully and complete the checklist. Be kind and helpful.

Check	Yes	Needs work	Suggestion
The email has a clear subject.	☐	☐	
The greeting is appropriate.	☐	☐	
The purpose is clear.	☐	☐	
The key information is included.	☐	☐	
The request/action is polite.	☐	☐	
The closing is appropriate.	☐	☐	
The email is easy to understand.	☐	☐	

After peer review, improve one email. Write your improved version below.

Activity 7 - Final email challenge

Choose one scenario. Write one individual email. Use the planning box first.

Scenario A - Supported	Scenario B - Standard	Scenario C - Challenge
You need to ask a colleague for a document before 4 p.m. Write a short polite email.	You need to inform a visitor that their appointment has changed. Include the new date, time and room.	A supplier sent the wrong invoice. Explain the problem politely and ask for a corrected invoice.

Planning box

Scenario chosen	
Subject line	
Recipient / greeting	
Purpose	
Key information	
Request/action + closing	

Write your final email here.

Exit ticket - What can you do now?

Complete the sentences before you leave.

Today I learned how to write...

One useful email phrase is...

A professional email needs...

I still need help with...

Email writing is difficult because...

My mini email checklist

Before I send an email, I check...	My 3 favourite phrases from today
☐ Subject is clear ☐ Greeting is appropriate ☐ Purpose is clear ☐ Information is complete ☐ Tone is polite ☐ Closing is appropriate	1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____